Opportunity Pathways 2027: Selvane Valley, where children's earnings depend most on their parents' income

To: Monique Webb, Director of Programs
From: Research and Evaluation
Date: 18 November 2026
Subject: the 2027 region, for the board of trustees on 26 November

Recommendation

Opportunity Pathways should go to Selvane Valley. Of the province's eight regions, it is where children's earnings as adults depend most on their parents' long-run income: an intergenerational elasticity of 0.49, against 0.40 in Torvale Metro, the next highest, a gap of 0.09.

How the elasticity was measured

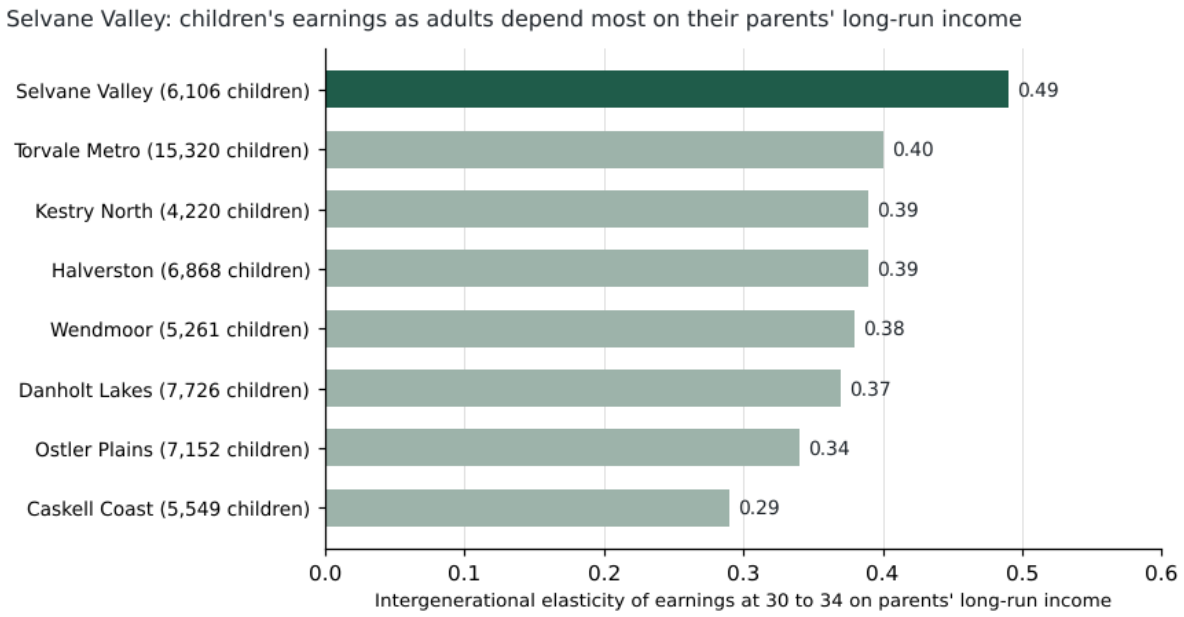
The children are the 58,202 born from 1984 to 1988 who lived with a parent in the province at the 2001 census, had parents' census income above zero and had earnings in at least one year from 30 to 34, each placed in the region of the 2001 household. A child's earnings are the average of the five years at 30 to 34 in 2005 dollars, years without earnings counted as zero.

Long-run income is observed for no family. The census gives every family's income for one year, 2000, and one year's income moves around the family's long-run level: in each region part of the spread of census incomes is that year-to-year swing, which flattens the slope of children's earnings on it. The tax history measures the swing directly, as the variance of each family's income around its own five-year level from 2001 to 2005, region by region. Taking that variance out of the spread of the census incomes leaves the spread of long-run income, and each region's elasticity is the covariance of children's earnings with the census income over that spread.

The tax history itself covers only the families in which a parent filed in every year, 58 per cent of the children's families across the province and as few as 27 per cent in Wendmoor. They are the better-off families in most regions, so a slope measured on them alone describes a narrower slice of the region and would put Halverston first. What carries from them to every family is the size of the year-to-year swing, not how reliable one year's income is among them, since that depends on how far apart their long-run incomes sit.

Region	Children	Elasticity	Census-year slope	Year-to-year swing (variance of log income)
Selvane Valley	6,106	0.49	0.23	0.137
Torvale Metro	15,320	0.40	0.33	0.147
Kestry North	4,220	0.39	0.18	0.223
Halverston	6,868	0.39	0.29	0.109
Wendmoor	5,261	0.38	0.15	0.216
Danholt Lakes	7,726	0.37	0.23	0.122
Ostler Plains	7,152	0.34	0.21	0.187
Caskell Coast	5,549	0.29	0.15	0.159

Census-year slope: the slope on one year's income before the swing is taken out. Source: Provincial Research Data Centre, linked intergenerational income extract, 2026 release. Figures from the extract go to the centre for its release check before the board papers are published (user guide, section 7).



Every child born 1984 to 1988 in the region at the 2001 census. Parents' 2000 census income, its year-to-year swing (measured within families over the 2001 to 2005 tax years) taken out of the spread. Source: Provincial Research Data Centre, linked extract, 2026 release.

Bridges in each region, 2019 to 2023

Young people are counted once, in the region of the office where they first enrolled: a case carried from CaseTrack into Northstar in April 2021 and a move to another office continue the same young person. Spending is each office's ledger with the December accruals taken back (the central reversal each January undoes them and the December invoices are posted in January), plus the central team's costs shared by the young people each region started, through the close-out in March 2024.

Region	Young people started	Spending
Torvale Metro	318	$1,442,000
Halverston	151	$830,000
Kestry North	117	$682,000
Selvane Valley	163	$818,000
Danholt Lakes	193	$973,000
Caskell Coast	128	$689,000
Ostler Plains	171	$853,000
Wendmoor	112	$621,000
Province	**1,353**	**$6,909,000**

Source: Bridges participant export, program ledger and office list. Each region is rounded to the thousand on its own; the province total is rounded from the unrounded sum.